
“A number of approaches to the heart of the race problem have been tried: religious, educational, political, industrial, ethical, economic, sociological.... Today a newer approach is being tried, an approach which discards most of the older methods.... It depends more upon what the Negro himself does than upon what someone else does for him. It is the approach along the line of intellectual and artistic achievement by Negroes, and may be called the art approach to the Negro problem.... The results of this method seem to carry a high degree of finality, to be the thing itself that was to be demonstrated....

But it should be borne in mind that the conscious [African American] artist is not an entirely new thing. What is new about him is chiefly the evaluation and public recognition of his work.”

Source: James Weldon Johnson, African American author, “Race Prejudice and the Negro Artist,” 1928

1. Respond to parts A, B, C, and D.

- A. Describe one example of African American art, literature, or music that challenged racial barriers or stereotypes.
- B. Explain how the author’s opinions reflect a principle of the New Negro movement.
- C. Using a specific example, explain how an African American leader or activist advocated for racial uplift in the nineteenth century.
- D. Describe one way the Black Arts movement or the Black is Beautiful movement contributed to racial uplift for African Americans in the twentieth or twenty-first century.